

NOTE

The specific limits of trial plans tend to change periodically, as hosting platforms fight spam and abuse of resources. You can see the current limits of the free trial at <https://platform.sh/free-trial>.

Installing the Platform.sh CLI

To deploy and manage a project on Platform.sh, you'll need the tools available in the Command Line Interface (CLI). To install the latest version of the CLI, visit <https://docs.platform.sh/development/cli.html> and follow the instructions for your operating system.

On most systems, you can install the CLI by running the following command in a terminal:

```
$ curl -fsS https://platform.sh/cli/installer | php
```

After this command has finished running, you will need to open a new terminal window before you can use the CLI.

NOTE

This command will probably not work in a standard terminal on Windows. You can use Windows Subsystem for Linux (WSL) or a Git Bash terminal. If you need to install PHP, you can use the XAMPP installer from <https://apachefriends.org>. If you have any difficulty installing the Platform.sh CLI, see the more detailed installation instructions in Appendix E.

Installing platformshconfig

You'll also need to install one additional package, `platformshconfig`. This package helps detect whether the project is running on your local system or on a Platform.sh server. In an active virtual environment, issue the following command:

```
(ll_env)learning_log$ pip install platformshconfig
```

We'll use this package to modify the project's settings when it's running on the live server.

Creating a requirements.txt File

The remote server needs to know which packages Learning Log depends on, so we'll use `pip` to generate a file listing them. Again, from an active virtual environment, issue the following command:

```
(ll_env)learning_log$ pip freeze > requirements.txt
```

The `freeze` command tells `pip` to write the names of all the packages currently installed in the project into the file `requirements.txt`. Open this file to see the packages and version numbers installed in your project:

```
requirements.txt asgiref==3.5.2
beautifulsoup4==4.11.1
Django==4.1
```
